GLASSHOUSE

SCRIPT FOR A TEARJERKER



Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

Several Congress leaders did not mind the opportunity presented by the recent Enforcement Directorate notices to party president Sonia Gandhi and her son Rahul to stir up sympathy for the Family. Braving Delhi's scorching heat, they hit the streets to protest the alleged harassment of their leaders by government agencies. More drama followed. On June 13, as Rahul was being grilled by the ED, he used the lunch break to visit his mother, who was being treated for Covid in isolation at Sir Ganga Ram Hospital in Delhi. Rahul may have been anxious about his mother but it didn't stop his detractors from saying that he had probably gone to take dictation for out-of-syllabus questions thrown by the ED.



NO HOUSE FOR MR SINGH

First he was denied a Rajya Sabha nomination, now it seems **R.C.P. Singh** will have to vacate the government bungalow on 7, Strand Road in Patna too. Originally allocated to an MLC, Singh had been occupying the house for over 10 years. His rise had been swift—from being Nitish Kumar's principal secretary to being twice JD(U) RS member, the party national president before becoming Union minister. But the denial of the RS nomination could cut short his cabinet stint, marking the start of Singh's free fall in politics.



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Widening Rift

Even as Telangana CM **K. Chandrashekar Rao** plans to pursue his ambitions in national politics, his rift with state governor **Tamilisai Soundararajan** is widening. They have not met in a year, though Hyderabad's Raj Bhavan and KCR's home-office are barely two kilometres apart. On June 10, in the wake of the May 28 Jubilee Hills student gang rape, Soundararajan hosted a Mahila Durbar to interact with women, hear their grievances, receive suggestions and forward them to the government. The TRS termed it a ploy at the behest of the BJP.

Car Wapsi

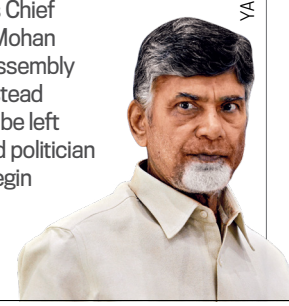


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The Keshav Dev Maurya-led Mahan Dal ended its alliance with Samajwadi Party in Uttar Pradesh when the SP's list of MLC candidates gave preference to former minister Swami Prasad Maurya over Keshav Dev. Not only that, SP leaders asked Keshav Dev to return a car he had received as a Diwali gift from Akhilesh Yadav last year. While Keshav Dev called it a "shameful act", it was only SP's response to his breaking the alliance.

POLL YATRAS BEGIN

Come June 15 and Telugu Desam Party supremo **N. Chandrababu Naidu** will embark on a vigorous campaign at Chodavaram in Anakapalle district, where he'll conduct a mini Mahanadu (annual conclave). Naidu is set to attend public meetings in all 26 districts of Andhra Pradesh and tour the entire state in a year to rally TDP rank and file and enlist public support. He expects Chief Minister Y.S. Jagan Mohan Reddy to advance assembly polls to next year instead of April 2024. Not to be left behind, actor-turned politician Pawan Kalyan will begin his Jana Sena's 'bus yatra' on October 5 from Tirupati.



YASIR IQBAL

–Kaushik Deka with Prashant Srivastava, Amarnath K. Menon and Amitabh Srivastava